food processing, and the improvement of foods for the consuming public".

Food has been a basic part of our survival. Next to air and water, food is the utmost important thing for survival. Food is essential for growth, development, active and healthy life of an individual. Through, centuries, food has also been used, as an expression of love, friendship and social acceptance.

Food refers to anything, which nourishes the body. It would include solids, semi-solids and liquids which when consumed help to sustain the body and keep it healthy. Food is a substance, which after ingestion, digestion and absorption is capable of being utilized by the body for its various functions.

3.2 FUNCTIONS OF FOOD

Food is classified according to their functions in the body as shown in Figure 1.

3.2.1 Physiological Functions of Food

The physiological functions of food can be further sub divided as follows

a. Energy yielding foods
b. Body building foods
c. Protective and regulatory food.

a) Energy Yielding Foods

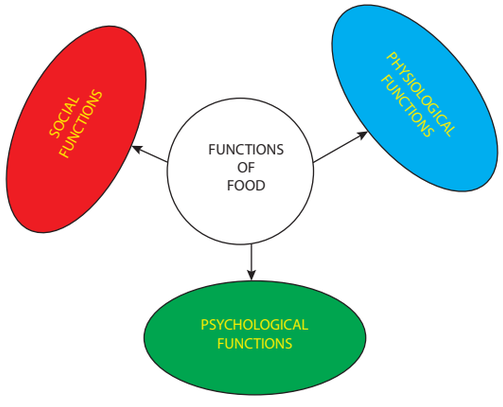
Food Sources: Cereals, millets, roots and tubers, sweets, jaggery, sugar, fats and oils.

Energy is mainly provided to our body through carbohydrates and fats in the food. Carbohydrates and fats provide energy to sustain involuntary processes in the body for continuous life, to carry out voluntary activities like professional, household and recreational activities and to convert food ingested into usable nutrients in the body. The energy needed is metabolized by oxidation of foods consumed.

b) Body building foods

Food Sources: Pulses, legumes, meat, fish, poultry, egg, milk and milk products.

In our body there is continuous breakdown of old tissues and building up of new tissues going on at all ages irrespective of the apparent growth thus maintaining a need for body building nutrients.



▲ Fig 1 Functions of food

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